Pressing Roses and Eucalyptus

A thoughtful, step-by-step guide to rose petals, full blooms, and eucalyptus in your 12 x 12-inch HWABELLE press.



Fresh flowers, carefully prepared, beautifully remembered.

ROSE + EUCALYPTUS EDITION

Begin with curiosity, not perfection

Roses and eucalyptus bring two different challenges to the press: the rose head can be dense, while eucalyptus stems may be woody. Start with spare flowers and treat the first press as a small experiment.

KEEP ONE WHOLE

Press a full rose as your reference sample. It may remain thicker than individual petals.

SPLIT ONE BLOOM

Cut a spare rose lengthwise through its center and compare the flatter halves with the whole bloom.

TRY LOOSE PETALS

Separate a few petals and test them on their own. This gives you a flatter option for detailed layouts.

COLOR NOTE

Natural flower colors soften or shift as moisture leaves during drying. Some fading is normal, and the finished rose may look lighter or more muted than it did when fresh. Each variety responds a little differently.

USE THE KIT GUIDANCE

Follow the layer order and pressing guidance supplied with your HWABELLE kit. Flower thickness and moisture vary, so this booklet does not promise an exact drying time or exact finished color.

Choose a bloom worth learning from



Select fresh rose blooms and a modest eucalyptus sprig before you begin preparing the press.

Choose clean, fresh flowers with petals you want to keep. Set aside blooms with obvious bruising or damage, and start with a spare rose if the flower is sentimental.

Keep a small group for comparison: one whole rose head, one rose for a lengthwise split, and a few loose petals. For eucalyptus, choose a small sprig with leaves that can lie flat.

BEGINNER TIP

Separate your experiment flowers from any bouquet flowers you are not ready to cut or take apart.

The rose center can be surprisingly thick



Compare one whole rose head with the two halves of a matching bloom split lengthwise.

A rose head has a dense center and many overlapping petals. That center can make a whole bloom much thicker than a single petal or eucalyptus leaf.

Try a spare bloom whole, then split a second one lengthwise through the center. You can also test separate petals. The best result depends on the rose and the look you want, so compare rather than assume.

IF YOU CHOOSE TO SPLIT A BLOOM

Use a clean, sharp floral tool on a stable cutting board, keep your fingers clear of the cut, and work slowly. If you are unsure, ask an experienced adult to help.

Make each rose easier to arrange



Trim the stem and remove bulky pieces that would keep the flower from lying flat.

Work on a clean, dry surface. Trim the stem to the shape you want to preserve, then remove leaves or damaged outer petals that add bulk or distract from the bloom.

For a flatter sample, use the split halves or separate petals. Keep one whole flower aside so you can compare the finished results. Place delicate petals with tweezers or clean fingers.

TAKE YOUR TIME

Do not press a thick stem or folded cluster just because it fits on the sheet. If it lifts the paper, trim, separate, or choose a thinner sample.

Keep eucalyptus light and flat



Trim away bulky woody sections so the leaves and fine sprigs can rest on the paper.

Choose the leaves and small tips you want to keep. If a woody stem makes the paper tent upward, shorten it or separate a smaller leaf-bearing piece.

Arrange individual leaves or short, delicate sprigs. A few distinct shapes are often easier to place than one thick branch. Keep the green elements small enough to sit inside the 12 x 12-inch working area.

CHECK THE STACK

A flat paper sandwich is the goal. Remove or adjust any thick piece that creates a visible bump before you close the press.

Plan a compact botanical layout



Lay the fresh rose petals and eucalyptus on a blotting sheet before covering them.

Place the largest rose petals first, then add a few eucalyptus leaves to create a quiet line or frame. Keep specimens in a single layer, with small gaps so edges remain distinct.

Leave a clear margin around the arrangement. Keep the pieces close enough to feel intentional, but do not overlap petals or bunch several leaves into a thick knot.

COMPOSITION IDEA

Make a tiny test layout first. Move the pieces until the balance feels right, then take a quick reference photo before covering the flowers.

Cover the flowers before the clear plate



Lower a clean blotting sheet over the flowers so the botanicals are protected between paper layers.

Place the arranged flowers on the absorbent blotting sheet. Check that no petals or leaves extend beyond its edges.

Add a second blotting sheet directly over the flowers. The paper must sit between the fresh botanicals and the clear acrylic plate. Continue the stack using the layer order supplied with your press kit.

DO NOT SKIP THIS CHECK

The clear plate goes above the completed paper stack. It should not rest directly on bare petals or leaves.

Let the paper sit between flower and plate



The HWABELLE press is a 12 x 12-inch square acrylic press. Build the paper stack in the sequence supplied with your kit, keeping each flower between absorbent blotting sheets.

Before closing, check the order: arranged flowers, a blotting sheet over them, then the clear scalloped top plate. The acrylic plate should never sit directly on exposed petals.

HARDWARE CHECK

Keep the held top plate plain. Align it with the four corner posts, then place one black hand knob at each corner and tighten gradually and evenly. Do not force the plates or add extra hardware.

Set the assembled press on a flat, stable surface and follow the kit instructions for the pressing period. If a layer looks uneven or the plate will not seat naturally, reopen it and adjust the paper stack rather than forcing it closed.

Notice what each flower teaches you

YOUR PRACTICE NOTES

Rose variety / color:

Whole, split, or petals? What would you change next time?



When you are ready to open the press, loosen the knobs gradually and lift the layers carefully. If a specimen still feels flexible, place it back between clean blotting sheets and continue according to your kit guidance. Handle delicate petals gently.

A NORMAL PART OF DRYING

Colors naturally soften or shift as flowers dry. The finished rose and eucalyptus may not match their fresh colors exactly. This is part of preserving natural plant material, not a promise of a fixed shade.

Pressing flowers is an art. Mistakes happen, and trial and error are part of the process. A folded petal or a pale sample is useful feedback for the next try. Compare your whole rose, split rose, and loose petals, then choose the approach you like best.